

Ἑρμείας ὁ Κυρηναῖος

Hermias of Cyrene against the Sophists

eul_aid: jva

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine \(frg\)](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Hermias of Cyrene was a Hellenistic poet of the 3rd century BCE. He is an obscure figure, and no biographical details about his life survive beyond his origin in the Greek colony of Cyrene in North Africa.

His only known work is the satirical poem **The Apology for the Dogs**, which survives in fragments. Hermias's significance rests entirely on this poem, a notable example of Hellenistic animal satire. It parodies Platonic dialogue to mock the Stoic philosopher Zeno of Citium and his followers by having dogs present a philosophical defense. The work provides valuable insight into the use of satire for intellectual debate and the contemporary reception of Stoicism.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα πρὸς Σοφιστὰς · [Fragments Against Sophists](#) · 1 passages